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WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 5, 2026

After eBay nightmare, a push for tougher laws

Still wary couple says journalists need protection

By Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF

Ina and David Steiner fought in court for five years to hold eBay and some of its former executives liable for a horrific harassment and stalking campaign that was designed to stifle their reporting about the company.

Now that the Natick couple's lawsuit is settled and they will receive almost \$50

million plus \$7 million donated to charities, the Steiners say they feel a sense of vindication over exposing corporate wrongdoing and potentially deterring similar excesses. And they feel an obligation to help protect journalists against corporate campaigns trying to quash critical media coverage.

But the Steiners' day-to-day lives remain scarred by the harassment they suffered. Their house is now equipped with security cameras and they are hypervigilant and nervous if an unexpected

EBAY, Page A7

'I believe the community deserves the opportunity to participate in a thoughtful, evidence-based process before we make a longer-term decision. This . . . is not about reaching a predetermined outcome.'

COUNCILOR
SUMBUL SIDDIQUI

Gunshot detector going back on in Cambridge

Council reverses decision after fatal shooting

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — After years of in-depth debate, Cambridge elected leaders in May took what they said was a principled stand on a technology used by the city's police and first responders, and turned off the ShotSpotter gunfire detection system be-

cause they believed it was ineffective, or worse, at addressing gun violence.

Then, after the July Fourth fatal shooting of a city worker who wasn't found for perhaps an hour, councilors did what politicians seldom do so quickly: They changed their minds.

Officials came under intense criticism, including from some Black community leaders who said the people most impacted by gun violence didn't have enough say in the initial decision.

So on Monday night, councilors voted 6-3 to turn ShotSpotter's network of microphones back on for at least the next few months while a 90-day public review gets underway.

Depending on the audience, it was either a flip-flop under pressure, or a show of humility from elected leaders willing to give the public more say in how decisions are made.

Councilor Marc McGovern, who changed his vote, said it's the latter.

SHOTSPOTTER, Page A7



WHY MASS. LOST ITS
MOJO — AND HOW
WE GET IT BACK

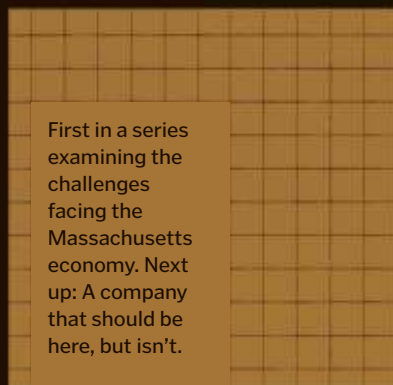


PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY LUIS G. RENDON/GLOBE STAFF; PHOTOS: FINN GOMEZ AND CARLIN STIEHL FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE, LANE TURNER, SUZANNE KREITER, AND DAVID L. RYAN /GLOBE STAFF

Soaring costs and a broken housing market have turned a miracle into a cautionary tale

BY LARRY EDELMAN | GLOBE COLUMNIST

The alarm is going off, but Massachusetts keeps hitting snooze. Its economy is slouching toward a future far less extraordinary than its past.

COMMENTARY Other states once envied our powerful mix of knowledge-based industries. Today, we are a cautionary tale about the pernicious effects of building too few homes and tolerating a business climate that is, to put it charitably, "challenging."

Making matters worse is a hostile Trump administration intent on undermining the support columns of our economy: medical and science research funding, higher education, and our community of foreign-born students and workers.

Boston has lost its swagger. Talk to people across industries and you'll hear that the boundless vibrancy we once took for granted has faded. The World Cup brought a jolt of energy that disappeared as suddenly as it arrived, a reminder of how enervated this city, especially downtown, can feel.

ECONOMY, Page A10

Squeezing the life out of independent restaurants

By Devra First
GLOBE STAFF

From Durgin Park to No. 9 Park, Boston has seen too many restaurants close in recent years. But the news that the South End's Bar Mezzana, No Relation, and Shore Leave would shutter was a shock.

CRITIC'S NOTEBOOK "It came down to a business decision," said Colin Lynch of Traveler Street Hospitality, which will close the restaurants at the end of the year. (The group also closed FIDO Pizza in Allston in June. South End restaurant Black Lamb will remain open.) Renewing their lease ultimately didn't make sense, Lynch said. "I do think the economy is going to come back, but we all kind of looked at each other and said: Do we want to grind it out three to four years to get there?"

Restaurants close, as surely as they open. The closing of these particular restaurants feels notable. They are successful. They helped turn their corner of the South End into a dining

RESTAURANTS, Page A10



After eight years in the Seaport, Chickadee closed its doors, an all-too-familiar story in Boston for spots that aren't chains.

BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE



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Lindsay Clancy appeared calm and competent as she spoke publicly for the first time at her murder trial. **B1.**

An appeals court said the Trump administration improperly terminated billions of dollars in funds to boost clean energy. **A2.**

The Red Sox kept on winning, this time pounding the White Sox, 14-2. **C1.**